SPACE VERSE

UX CASE STUDY BY NIKOLA MILIĆEVIĆ

AI assisted lyrics writing & mobile studio

SpaceVerse is a creative tool prototype that helps music artists write lyrics, generate ideas, and capture recordings - all within one structured workflow.

Role: **Lead UX/UI Designer**
Platform: **Web + Mobile**
Timeline: **2025**
Focus: **Concept design, research, MVP definition, prototyping, usability testing, design system foundations**

Problem I solved

Artists lose creative momentum because lyric writing, beat playback, and recording live across fragmented tools.

Outcome

Delivered an end-to-end MVP experience that keeps artists in a "creative flow" from idea → writing → recording, reducing context switching between apps.

Why SpaceVerse?

Songwriting tools are fragmented - lyrics live in notes, beats live in multiple apps, recordings live elsewhere.

- **Lyrics tools:** Genius, Google Docs/Keep
- **Beat/Lyrics Playback:** Spotify/YouTube (backtracks)
- **Lyrics Generator:** ChatGPT, Rhyme Zone
- **Recordings:** Voice Memos, BandLab

This constant switching breaks creative focus and makes it difficult to keep songs organized.

DESIGN CHALLENGE

How might we build a lightweight "mobile studio" for lyric writing that preserves flow and structure, without turning the product into a full DAW?

Product goals

- Enable artists to capture ideas fast (voice + text)
- Reduce friction caused by switching tools
- Organize creations into projects/albums
- Provide assistive tools (AI, rhyme, freestyle prompts) without replacing creativity

Success criteria

- New users understand the product within 10 seconds
- Users can create a project and start writing in 3 minutes
- Users can access core tools without confusion
- Users successfully save/access a song idea without external tools

Responsibilities & ownership

I led the product design end-to-end, including:

- User discovery + competitive research
- Defining MVP features & prioritization
- Information architecture + user flows
- Wireframes + high-fidelity UI
- Prototypes & usability testing
- Design system foundations (components, tokens, patterns)
- Handoff ready documentation for implementation

Research

APPROACH

To validate the real pain points and identify high-leverage product direction, I conducted:

- **competitive scan** of lyric writing and music creation tools
- **user interviews** with artists and songwriting creators
- **synthesis** using affinity mapping

Competitive analysis

	Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4	Step 5	Step 6	Step 7
Genius	Lyrics	Annotations	Rhyme Suggestions	Community Edits	Mobile App	Chrome Extension	Verified Artists
Rentrak	Lyrics	Beat Library	Recording	Mixing	Mastering	Distribution	Analytics
Rhyme Zone	Rhyme Search	Synonyms	Slant Rhymes	Multi-syllable Rhymes	Phrase Suggestions	Usage Examples	Save Words
Rapchat	Lyrics	Beat Library	Recording	Mixing	Mastering	Distribution	Analytics

User interviews

Below are quotes that represent some of the most important insights that I gathered during the interviews.

> I have a 3-4 different platforms when creating. Sometimes I'm in the car and I have to remember the lyrics. Sometimes I'm in the studio and I have to open my phone to see what I wrote.
>
> Sometimes I just go to sleep and I think of something, I have to wake up and write it down because I'm forgetting everything I thought of.
>
> I have my phone on Notes app. Sometimes I'm in the car and I'm thinking of something. I am using Voice Memo app.
>
> I want to have my notes app, Spotify app, Voice Memo app, Chrome app, all in one place. I want to be able to find everything I need in one place.
>
> I want to have my notes app with songs and lyrics, I want to have a beat library, I want to have a place to store everything I need in one place.
>
> I have a different app for every writing step. I have a different app for my lyrics, I have a different app for my beats and I have a different app for my recordings.

KEY INSIGHTS

- Artists use 4-7 apps per song, and switching kills momentum
- Structure matters, users want "prompts" not loose lyric files
- Recording motivates writing ("flow like crazy" when capturing audio)
- Ideas are fragile, they disappear if capture is slow
- Users want to keep their technical creativity, not replace it

PRODUCT DIRECTION

Instead of overbuilding tools, the direction became clear - the core value is a single creative workflow:

Project → **Lyrics tools** → **Beat playback** → **Recording** → **Save/share**

This leaves a foundation for:

- Collaboration
- AI
- Texture prioritization
- Voice interactivity

Define/ideate

User persona

After I completed the synthesis from the research into the affinity map, I was able to create a persona that represents the main user group.

User journey

This user journey was created by synthesized research from the competitive analysis and user interviews, showing what are the biggest pain points and what features can solve them.

	Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4
Task	Voice Memo app - save an idea	Write lyrics	Record a song	Save/Share
Challenges	Sometimes it can be difficult to find the app in a cluttered home	It's not always easy to find a place to write when inspiration strikes	It may be quite difficult to find a place to record a song	Didn't find the right app for this step, so I'm using a different one
Opportunity	In a app based Widget	Connect users with different tools for inspiration	In-app audio recorder/editor	In-app discoverability of projects

MVP scope

INCLUDED IN MVP

- Project creation + organization
- Lyrics editor (Core)
- AI assistant (Chat UI + modes)
- Beat library + playback (Audio core)
- Beat attachment integration (Optional beat to project)
- Voice recorder/Dictaphone
- Save/share/Export

INTENTIONALLY OUT OF SCOPE

- Full DAW editing/mixing
- Social feed / community
- Collaboration (planned later)

Information architecture

Wireframes

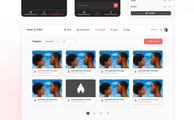
The wireframe is a previous wireframe early usability tests, revealing key revisions that needed immediate implementation. This reduced the number of iterations for later versions, allowing me to focus on creating the high-fidelity interface.

Design

UI kit

COLOR PALETTE

BUTTONS



FONTS

H1 – Poppins Bold/Semibold 24

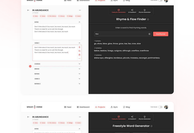
H2 – Poppins Semibold 20

H3 – Poppins Medium 16

Body – Poppins Regular/Medium 14

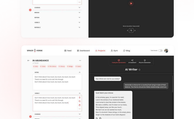
Inc. - Poppins Regular 12

ICONS



High-fidelity prototype

Prototype:
https://www.figma.com/proto/Ffq7Ldc1Ibq0ZJ7Ge1Ldq0/Design-in-Motion?node-id=1-3&t=3Ldq0ewc1Ldq0-1&scaling=min-zoom&content-scaling=fixed&page-block=1&hide-ui=1&starting-point-node-id=1:3&show-proto-sidebar=1&mode=design&t=Ldq0ewc1Ldq0-1



Test

Usability testing

TEST SETUP

Participants: **5**
Method: **Moderated prototype testing** (Figma)
Tasks:

- **create a project and add lyrics**
- **locate and use rhyme tool**
- **attach and play a beat**
- **record and save a voice note**

Results:

- **95%** task completion rate
- **100%** focus on comprehension (project structure + tools)
- Biggest friction: tool discoverability and icon clarity

Prioritized Issues - Fixes:

- Users hesitated on tool icons
  - **Fix:** Added labels + improved hierarchy
- Users weren't sure where to "start"
  - **simplified onboarding + stronger empty state CTA**
- Some actions felt hidden
  - **Increased contrast & layout priority for studio actions**

QUOTE/FEEDBACK/TESTIMONIALS

While the testing groups confirmed that the product is ready for launch, it also highlighted opportunities for future iteration and improvement.

Feedback suggested focus on AI creating long-term engagements, strengthening content interaction, and addressing minor usability issues. These insights will guide future iterations and ensure the product remains intuitive and a solid foundation rather than sacrifices usability.

Conclusion

The testing process allowed a structured iteration cycle, validating key design decisions and ensuring a high level of usability before development. The prioritized fixes addressed critical friction points in tool discoverability, the first experience (onboarding), consistency, and visual hierarchy across core interactions.

The phase reinforced the value of iterative validation and evidence-based design, ensuring that the product moved forward with minimal usability risk and a strong, user-centered foundation.